

Since $\sqrt{x} > 0$, the selection of $\varepsilon < 1$ a fortiori (which of course, does not impair the generality of our proof) ^{Even stronger reason} allows us to square the last inequalities

$$(1-\varepsilon)^2 < x < (1+\varepsilon)^2$$

On removing the parentheses, we obtain $(-2\varepsilon + \varepsilon^2) < (x-1) < (2\varepsilon + \varepsilon^2)$ (4)

Note that inequalities (4) are equivalent to (3) (provided that $0 < \varepsilon < 1$). Now let us proceed from (4) to a more exacting inequality:

$$|x-1| < (2\varepsilon - \varepsilon^2) \quad (5) \quad (\text{since } 0 < \varepsilon < 1, \text{ we have } (2\varepsilon - \varepsilon^2) > 0).$$

It is easy to conclude that if (5) holds, inequalities (4) and, consequently, (3) will hold all the more. Thus, for an arbitrary ε within $0 < \varepsilon < 1$, it is sufficient to take $\delta = 2\varepsilon - \varepsilon^2$.

Reader: What happens if $\varepsilon > 1$?

Author: Then δ determined for any $\varepsilon < 1$ will be adequate a fortiori.

Reader: Apparently, we may state that $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \sqrt{x} = \sqrt{2}$, $\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \sqrt{x} = \sqrt{3}$ and, in general,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a} \sqrt{x} = \sqrt{a}.$$

Author: Yes, that's right.

Reader: But could we generalize it to $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = f(a)$.

Author: Yes, it is often the case. But not always. Because the function $f(x)$ may be undefined at point a . Remember that the limit of the function $x \sin \frac{1}{x}$ at point $x=0$, but the function itself is not defined at $x=0$.

Reader: But perhaps the equality $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = f(a)$ can be considered as valid in all the cases when $f(x)$ is defined at point a ?

Author: This may not be correct either. Consider, for example, a function which is called the "fractional part of x ". The standard notation for this function is $\{x\}$. The function is defined on the whole real line. We shall divide the real line into half-intervals $[n, n+1]$. For x in $[n, n+1]$ we have